



DUNGEON WORLD

OFFICIAL RULEBOOK

Powered by the Apocalypse fantasy dungeon-crawling, fiction-first play

2-5	varies	13+
PLAYERS	MINUTES	AGE

Published by Moddable Games • v0.1.0 • Printed 22 July 2026

DUNGEON WORLD

Dungeon World is a tabletop RPG by Sage LaTorra and Adam Koebel that applies the Powered by the Apocalypse (PbtA) engine, originated by D. Vincent Baker's *Apocalypse World*, to fantasy dungeon-crawling. Instead of a GM adjudicating a rules simulation, players and GM narrate the fiction first; when a character's action fits a move's trigger, the player rolls 2d6 and the result (10+, 7-9, 6-) determines the outcome in evocative, fiction-forward language. The GM never rolls dice – instead they make moves of their own, following an explicit agenda and set of principles.

Licence: Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported (CC BY 3.0). **Attribution:** Dungeon World is created by Sage LaTorra and Adam Koebel. Content sourced from the authors' own GitHub repository ([Sage1t/Dungeon-World](#)), the canonical text of the book.

RULES

Getting Started

- ♦ [Introduction](#) – What Dungeon World is, per-class flavor, how to use the book, setting up a session
- ♦ [Playing the Game](#) – Ability scores, making moves, harm and healing, magic, leveling up, bonds, alignment, hirelings
- ♦ [Basic Moves](#) – Hack and Slash, Volley, Defy Danger, Defend, Spout Lore, Discern Realities, Parley, Aid or Interfere, with worked examples
- ♦ [Special Moves](#) – Last Breath, Encumbrance, Make Camp, Take Watch, Undertake a Perilous Journey, End of Session, Level Up, Carouse, Supply, Recover, Recruit, Outstanding Warrants, Bolster
- ♦ [Character Creation](#) – The 13-step process, ability score modifiers, worked example

Classes

- ♦ [Bard](#) – Arcane Art, Bardic Lore, Charming and Open, A Port in the Storm
- ♦ [Cleric](#) – Deity, Divine Guidance, Turn Undead, Commune, Cast a Spell, full spell list
- ♦ [Druid](#) – Born of the Soil, Shapeshifter, Spirit Tongue, Studied Essence
- ♦ [Fighter](#) – Bend Bars Lift Gates, Armored, Signature Weapon
- ♦ [Paladin](#) – Lay on Hands, I Am the Law, Quest
- ♦ [Ranger](#) – Hunt and Track, Called Shot, Animal Companion, Command
- ♦ [Thief](#) – Trap Expert, Tricks of the Trade, Backstab, Poisoner
- ♦ [Wizard](#) – Spellbook, Prepare Spells, Cast a Spell, Ritual, full spell list

Running the Game

- ♦ [The GM](#) — Agenda, principles, GM moves, dungeon moves, dealing with common situations
- ♦ [Fronts](#) — Dangers, grim portents, impending dooms, stakes, a worked example front
- ♦ [The World](#) — Steadings, campaign maps, steading tags, making villages/towns/keeps/cities
- ♦ [First Session](#) — Prep, getting started, the first adventure, GM goals
- ♦ [Example of Play](#) — An annotated play transcript from a goblin ambush
- ♦ [Advanced Delving](#) — Hacking the game: custom moves, new classes, compendium classes, adventure moves, monster hacking

Equipment

- ♦ [Equipment](#) — Tags, weapons, armor, dungeon gear, poisons, services, magic items

Bestiary

- ♦ [Monsters](#) — Monster tags, making monsters, treasure, the nine monster settings

Appendices

- ♦ [Adventure Conversion](#) — Converting published adventures and other-system monsters to Dungeon World
- ♦ [Instant NPCs](#) — 100 instincts, 100 knacks, and a name list for improvised NPCs
- ♦ [Teaching the Game](#) — Pitching the game, presenting classes, running a first session

MACHINE-READABLE DATA

Structured JSON, sourced from [Sage1t/Dungeon-World](#) (CC BY 3.0).

- ♦ [classes.json](#) — The 8 core classes with HP, damage die, and a short summary
- ♦ [cavern-dwellers.json](#) — Goblins, ankhegs, gargoyles, purple worms, and other cave and tunnel dwellers
- ♦ [lower-depths.json](#) — Aboleths, dragons, minotaurs, nagas, and the deep-dwelling terrors of ancient ruins
- ♦ [twisted-experiments.json](#) — Chimeras, golems, manticores, owlbears, and other creations of arcane hubris
- ♦ [folk-of-the-realm.json](#) — Bandits, knights, nobles, spies, and the ordinary (and not-so-ordinary) people of the world
- ♦ [ravenous-hordes.json](#) — Formians, gnolls, orcs, and tritons organized for war and conquest
- ♦ [planar-powers.json](#) — Angels, devils, djinn, and the other creatures that slip through from beyond this world
- ♦ [swamp-denzens.json](#) — Basilisks, hydras, lizardmen, trolls, and the rot and ruin of the fens
- ♦ [undead-legions.json](#) — Ghosts, liches, vampires, zombies, and the many shapes death's magic takes
- ♦ [dark-woods.json](#) — Centaurs, dryads, treants, werewolves, and the sylvan monsters of the ancient forest



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